CLAY BUIOCCHI

Game Designer
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SKILLS

Design: UI/UX for games, systems design, game design documentation, level design & encounter design, playtesting & iteration, narrative design, sound design
Technical: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints, UMG), Godot (GDScript), Figma, Aseprite, Blender fundamentals, DAWs (Logic Pro)
Cross-Disciplinary: reading engagement & frustration cues in real time, scaffolding difficulty, behavior & feedback loop design, de-escalation / pacing, multitasking, communication

GAME DESIGN PROJECTS

Deckborn: 3D Single-Player Deckbuilding RPG | Bootcamp Capstone Project
claybuiocchi.itch.io/deckborn

- Wrote a Game Design Document covering full scope of game, split into both exploration and combat sections.
- Built deckbuilding card system using data types and UMG
- Created small open world and dungeon with roaming enemies and shop for modifying deck

Wrong Bird: Pet Training Prototype | Portfolio Piece
claybuiocchi.itch.io/wrong-bird-training-loop-prototype

- Wrote a GDD with full scope of game, with both training and launch sequences planned out
- Developed training loop in UE5
- Used UMG to make intuitive UI/UX inside of Unreal Engine
- Built RNG based system using data types and Blueprints

EDUCATION

Circuit Stream: Game Design Bootcamp | Certificate of Completion
Intensive program covering game design fundamentals, Unreal Engine 5 development, and portfolio production

Wheaton College
Bachelor of Arts, Music Major, Psychology Minor | Norton, MA

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

First Circle Learning Center Sept 2024 – Present
Teacher | Lexington, MA

- Support development across infant, toddler, and preschool classrooms; EEC-certified in all three.
- Engage children with play materials and routines, then iterate on activities based on what holds attention and builds confidence.

Austen Riggs Nursery School Jan 2024 – June 2024
Teacher's Aide | Stockbridge, MA

- Supported ages 2-6 in daily activities and learning.
- Designed and led interactive music sessions that adapted in real time to group energy and participation, building skills in pacing, audience awareness, and creating shared experiences.

Justice Resource Institute May 2021 – Oct 2023
Therapeutic Mentor and Counselor, Community Based Services | Acton, MA

- Provided in-home care for children with complex behavioral needs; served on a multi-disciplinary intervention team.
- Collaborated with clinicians, families, and educators to translate individual needs into practical strategies, honing cross-functional communication and user-centered problem solving.

Justice Resource Institute, Walden Street School Sept 2020 – May 2021
Residential Counselor | Concord, MA

- Supported safety and development for students with complex trauma through counseling and structured intervention.
- Built trust-based, trauma-informed environments where users felt safe to take risks, informing a design approach that prioritizes emotional safety, clear expectations, and meaningful progression.